

Would You Like Some 'Smarts' in Your Home?



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An automated stacking car lift packs your car into a garage, while you proceed to enter Kensington House at 16 South End, London W8. It has more than a couple of floors and, so, comes with its very own lift to take you up. Touchpanels give you control of the ₹ 25 million worth of electronics in the house connected via 30 kilometres of wiring and controlled by a computer server rack that by itself costs approximately ₹ 6 million.

For the kind of clients who would look for a place like this, there are special panic rooms inside the house protected by bomb-proof doors that can withstand the blast of 10 kilograms of trinitrotoluene

(TNT). It is not every day that you can watch your house get attacked by terrorists, as you relax in a warm bubble bath in your temperature-controlled bathtub, while catching up on the action unravelling outside.

A display in the panic bathroom lets you watch security footage and control your house from a bathtub using a waterproof remote. There are 24 audio zones and 16 cameras spread across the house that can be used to single-handedly run things like awesome parties, while making sure nothing gets out of hand.

The house also comes with a temperature-controlled cellar for storing red wines and a special humidor for cigars. To prevent your teenager from consuming the wine, the cellar comes with biometric access points. The cellar can also be programmed to send across a text to you if someone tries to get in.

There is also a ballroom with a dance floor that almost magically lowers itself into a swimming pool with just the press of a button.

But, how do we build something at least close to this?

Connection 1: The living room and the bedroom

Creston is introducing the next version of their DigitalMedia AV distribution technology with the new DM 3.0 standard that was introduced at InfoComm in Orlando, the USA, in June 2015. This means, you can create a movie experience through your living space without worrying about connectivity problems.

Just like Kensington House, you can have wireless touchscreens placed around your house to directly control various automations in it. You can connect these devices using standard technologies like Wi-Fi and Z-wave or go for specialised technology like Smartlabs' Insteon technology that uses power lines and radio frequency (RF) or Creston's Extended Range (ER) RF technologies. Often, there are equipment vendors who force you onto specific communication technologies but the above seem to be among the most popular.